MIL-T-83043A(USAF)
16 September 1974
SUPERSEDING
MIL-S-83043 (USAF)
13 June 1968

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

T-SHIRT, ATHLETE'S, AIR FORCE

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers one type of athletic T-shirt.

* 1.2 Classification. The T-shirt shall be furnished in one of the following sizes, as specified (see 6.2).

Small (34-36)	Large (42-44)
Medium (38-40)	Extra large (46-48)

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

* 2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specfied herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

V-T-276	Thread, Cotton
UU-P-268	Paper, Kraft, Untreated, Wrapping

Military

MIL-B-17757	Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated (Modular Sizes)

STANDARDS

Federal

FED-STD-191	Textile Test Methods
FED-STD-751	Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings

*

FSC 8415

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Military

MIL-STD-105 Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-1491 Glossary of Knitting Imperfections

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials

3.1.1 Cloth. The cloth for the body of the T-shirt shall be a knitted cotton cloth conforming to the requirements specified in table I. The cloth for the collarette of the T-shirt shall be a knitted cotton-nylon cloth conforming to the requirements specified in table II.

* TABLE I. Knitted Cloth for Body of T-Shirt

Characteristics	Requirements
Ply	Singles or two ply
Yarn, type and size	24/1 KP (24 singles carded peeler)
Texture	
Wales	29 per inch, minimum
Courses	38 per inch, minimum
Bursting strength	55 pounds, minimum
Color	White, bleached
Nonfibrous materials	2 percent maximum
Type of knit	Circular knit with a flat (jersey) stitch
Preshrinkage	1/
pH	5.5 to 8.5

1/ Before the cloth for the body is cut, it shall be preshrunk by a mechanical compacter shrinking process. The preshrinkage process shall not be identified by name or trademark on the T-shirt, the ticket, or the package.

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* TABLE II. Knitted Cloth for Collarette

Characteristics	Requirements
Type of knit	True 1 by 1 ribbed knit
Yarn, type and size	Blend of 80 percent cotton and 20 percent nylon, 26/1 CP (26 singles combed peeler)
Texture Wales Courses	 22 per inch, minimum 32 per inch, minimum
Color	Ultramarine blue matching standard color sample (see 6.3)
Type of dye	Vat
Nonfibrous materials	2 percent, maximum
Shrinkage or elongation wales and courses	8 percent, maximum 1/
Colorfastness to combined laundering and bleaching	Equal to or better than standard color sample (see 6.3)
pH	5.5 to 8.5

1/ Before the cloth for the collarette is cut, it shall be preshrunk by a mechanical compacter shrinking process. The preshrinkage process shall not be identified by name or trademark on the T-shirt, the ticket, or the package.

* 3.1.2 Thread. The thread shall conform to type IA2, ticket No. 70, 2 ply of V-T-276. Except for overseaming the collarette, the color of the thread shall be bleached white. The needle thread for overseaming the collarette shall be vat dyed ultramarine blue to match the collarette. The looper thread for overseaming the collarette may be either ultramarine blue or white at the option of the manufacturer.

* 3.1.3 Tape. The material for taping the neck and the shoulders shall be knitted cotton cloth that conforms to table I and shall be 3/8 (plus or minus 1/16) inch wide.

3.2 Construction. The T-shirt shall be constructed in accordance with table III, but the manufacturer is not required to follow the exact sequence of operations as listed therein.

3.2.1 Stitches, seams, and stitchings. The seam, stitch, and stitching types specified herein shall conform to FED-STD-751.

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TABLE III. Sewing Operations

No	Description of Operation	Cover Thread	Thread		Stitch Type	Seam and Stitch Type	Stitches Per Inch
			Top	Lower			
1	Cut						
*	(a) Except for the collarette, all parts shall be cut in the lengthwise direction of the wales.						
2	Close shoulder						
*	(a) Close one shoulder seam (for seamed collarette).	70-2	70-2	70-2	504	SSa-1	12-16
	OR						
	(b) Close both shoulder seams (for the seamless collarette).	70-2	70-2	70-2	504	SSa-1	12-16
3	Attach collarette						
*	(a) The collarette shall be a double thickness of the ribbed cloth. Seam the collarette to the T-shirt with the wales running perpendicular to the seam. The stitching shall cover all raw edges. The finished collarette shall be 1 inch (plus or minus 1/8 inch) wide.	70-2	70-2	70-2	504	SSa-1	12-16
4	Close other shoulder and collarette						
*	(a) Close the other shoulder and the collarette (not applicable when a seamless collarette is used).	70-2	70-2	70-2	504	SSa-1	12-16

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TABLE III. Sewing Operations (Cont)

No.	Description of Operation	Cover Thread	Thread		Stitch Type	Seam and Stitch Type	Stitches Per Inch
			Top	Lower			
5	Overseam collarette						
	(a) Overseam the collarette stitching from the shoulder seam across the back of the collarette, or tape the neck and the shoulders.		70-2	70-2	406		12-16
6	Sleeves						
	(a) Close each sleeve along the underarm.	70-2	70-2	70-2	504	SSa-1	12-16
	(b) Hem each sleeve bottom to finish 3/4 inch (plus or minus 1/4 inch) wide. The hems shall be stitched over the first end of stitching not less than 1 inch.		70-2	70-2	503	EFc-1	10-14
	OR						
	(c) Hem each sleeve bottom to finish 3/4 inch (plus or minus 1/4 inch).		70-2	70-2	503	EFc-1	10-14
	(d) Close each sleeve along the underarm.	70-2	70-2	70-2	504	SSa-1	12-16
	(e) Bartack as specified in No. 9(a) or 9(b).						
7	Set sleeves						
	(a) Set the sleeve to the armhole.	70-2	70-2	70-2	504	SSa-1	12-16
8	Hem bottom						
	(a) Hem the bottom of the T-shirt to finish 3/4 inch (plus or minus 1/4		70-2	70-2	503	EFc-1	10-14

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TABLE III. Sewing Operations (Cont)

No	Description of Operation	Cover Thread	Thread		Stitch Type	Seam and Stitch Type	Stitches Per Inch
			Top	Lower			
	inch) wide. The hem shall be stitched over the first end of the stitching not less than 1 inch.						
9	Tacking. Except for the seams of the hem and overseaming of the collarette, the ends of all stitches not caught in other seams or stitchings shall be securely tacked as specified in No.9(a) or 9(b).						
*	(a) Fold back the end of the stitching chain 1/4 to 3/8 inch, and bartack perpendicular to the seam 1/16 to 1/8 inch from the folded edge. The bartack shall be 1/2 inch (plus or minus 1/8 inch) long.		70-2	70-2	bartack		28 stitches per bartack
	OR						
	(b) Stitch the first and the last ends of the stitching chain back into the seam by means of an appropriate mechanical device.	70-2	70-2	70-2	504	SSa-1	12-14
10	Clean and press						
*	(a) Trim and remove raw edges and ends of the thread of stitching inside and outside of the T-shirt.						
	(b) Remove all spots and stains.						
*	(c) Press the T-shirt with a heated iron.						

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3.2.1.1 Thread breaks and ends of seams. Except for the seams of the hems and the overseaming of the collarette, the ends of seams and stitchings not caught in other seams and stitchings shall be securely tacked as specified in either No.9(a) or 9(b) of table III.

* 3.3 Lettering. The words U.S. AIR FORCE in 2-inch, narrow, block lettering shall be placed on the front of the T-shirt as shown in figure 1. The lettering shall be ultramarine blue and shall match the shade of the collarette. The lettering shall have good colorfastness to laundering and bleaching. Periods shall be required after "U" and "S" in the lettering.

3.4 Finished measurements and weight. After the T-shirt has been conditioned as specified herein, the finished measurements and the weight of the T-shirt shall conform to the requirements specified in table IV.

* 3.4.1 Shrinkage and elongation. The finished T-shirts shall not shrink or elongate more than 6 percent in measurements A, B, or C (see figure 2).

3.5 Patterns. The patterns shall be furnished by the manufacturer and shall be subject to the approval of the procuring activity.

* 3.6 Identification of product. Unless otherwise specified herein, each package (see 5.1.1 and 5.1.2) shall be marked directly on the face of the package to identify the T-shirts contained therein. If the T-shirts are packaged in plastic bags, a white paper label may be placed in the plastic bag so that the label is readable through the plastic in lieu of marking the face of the package. The following information shall be marked, in black, on the face of the package or on the white paper label.

T-Shirt, Athlete's, Air Force
Federal Stock No. 1/
Manufacturer's Name or Trademark 1/
Contract No. 1/
Size 1/

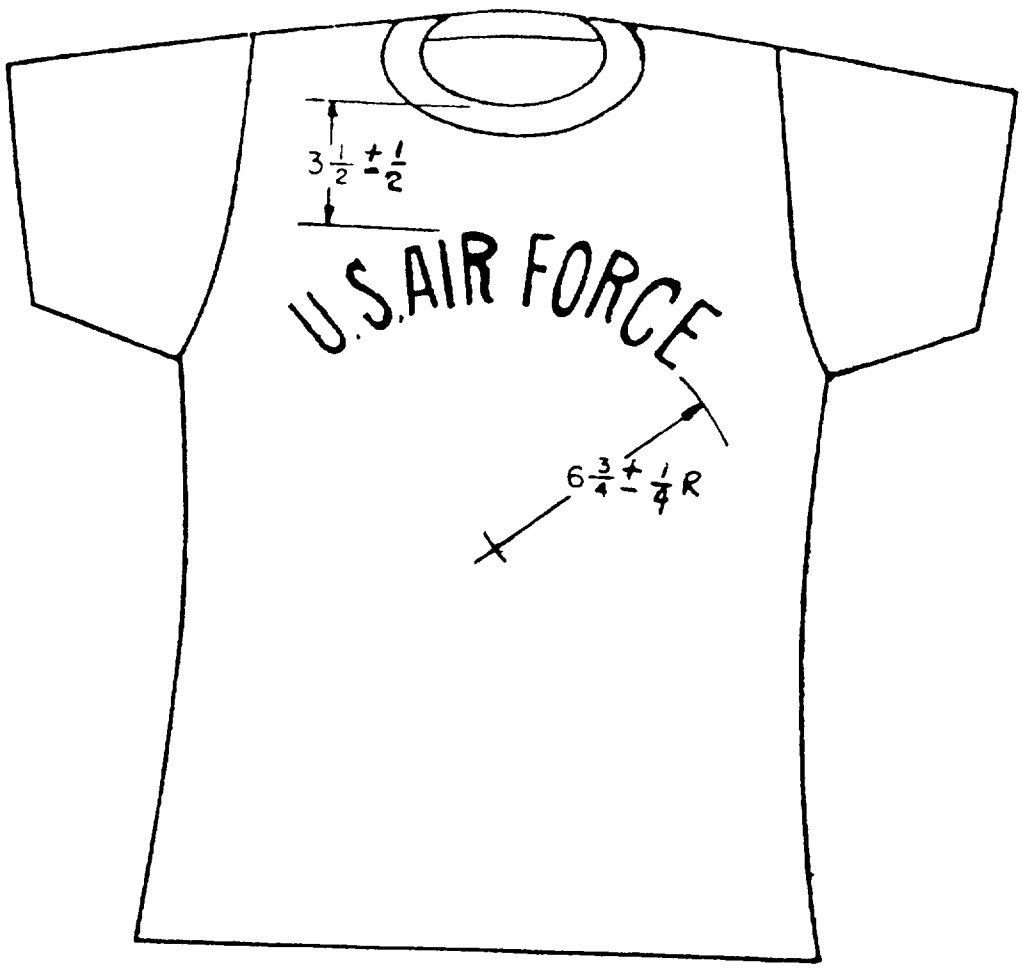
1/ The manufacturer shall insert the applicable information.

* 3.7 Workmanship. The T-shirt shall be manufactured in a thoroughly workmanlike manner.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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DIMENSIONS IN INCHES

FIGURE 1. Lettering

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TABLE IV. Finished Measurements and Weight

Size	Finished Measurements in Inches 1/							Weight per Dozen (Minimum)
	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	
* Small (34-36)	16-1/4	27-12	7	8-1/2	5-1/2	17	4-1/2	2 lb 9 oz
Medium (38-40)	18-1/2	29-1/2	7-1/2	9-1/2	5-1/2	17	5	3 lb 1 oz
Large (42-44)	21	30-1/2	7-1/2	10	8	19	5-1/2	3 lb 7 oz
* Extra large (46-48)	23-1/4	31-1/2	8	10	8	19	6	3 lb 15 oz
Tolerance	±1/2	±1	±1	±1/2	±1/2	±1	±1/2	

* 1/ The finished measurements A through G (see figure 2) shall be taken as follows: Take measurement A (width) 5 inches (plus or minus 1 inch) below the armpits. Take measurement B (length) from the bottom hem edge to the junction of the shoulder seam and the seam attaching the collarette to the body. Take measurement C (sleeve length) from the hemmed end of the sleeve to the shoulder seam. Take measurement D (armhole length) from the junction of the shoulder seam and the top of the armhole seam, on a straight line, to the bottom of the armhole seam. Take measurement E (sleeve width) from folded edge to folded edge, on the hemmed sleeve. Take measurement F (neck opening) along a straight edge, formed by grasping the collarette at the center back and the center front, and multiply by two. Take measurement G (shoulder length), along the shoulder seam, from the collarette seam to the top of the armhole seam.

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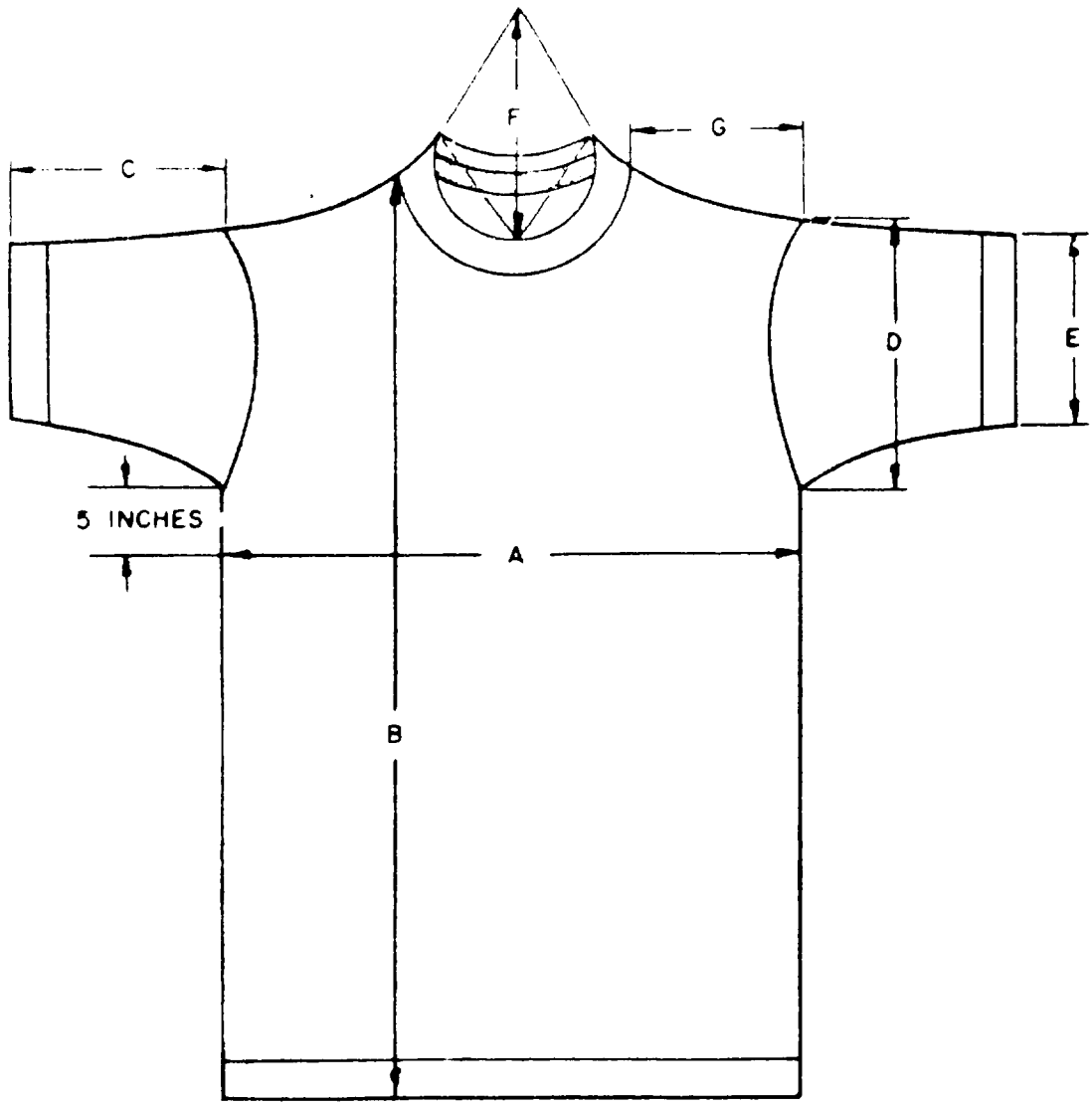


FIGURE 2. Measurements of T-Shirt

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* 4.2 Inspection

* 4.2.1 Materials. In addition to the quality assurance provisions of the specifications referenced herein, inspection shall be performed on the materials specified in table V for the characteristics listed therein. The unit for expressing lot size shall be yards. The sample unit shall be 2 yards full fabric width. The sample size shall conform to table VI. If one or more units fail to meet any specified requirement, the lot shall be rejected.

4.2.2 End item

* 4.2.2.1 Visual examination. The end item shall be visually examined for the defects listed in table VII. The definition of the knitting imperfections used in the defects listed in table VII shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-1491. The lot size for this visual examination shall be expressed in units of one T-shirt. The sample unit for this visual examination shall be one T-shirt. The inspection level for this visual examination shall be II of MIL-STD-105. The acceptable quality level for this visual examination shall be 1.5 defects per 100 units for major defects and 4.0 defects per 100 units for total (major and minor) defects.

4.2.2.2 Examination of finished measurements. The finished measurements of the end item shall be examined. Before this examination is made, the end item shall be conditioned in a normal plant atmosphere and in a relaxed supported state for a minimum of 1 hour. Any finished measurement not in accordance with the requirements specified in table IV shall be classified as a defect. The sample unit for this examination shall be one T-shirt. The lot size shall be expressed in the terms of one T-shirt. The inspection level for this examination shall be S-3 of MIL-STD-105. The acceptable quality level shall be 10.0 defects per 100 units (one class of defects).

* 4.2.2.3 Testing. The end item shall be tested as specified in table VIII. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one T-shirt. Except for shrinkage and elongation and weight, the sample unit shall be one T-shirt (any size in the lot). The sample unit for shrinkage and elongation shall be three T-shirts of each size in the lot. The sample unit for weight shall be one dozen T-shirts of each size in the lot. Regardless of the lot size, the sample size for weight shall be one sample unit with an acceptance number of zero. The sample size shall conform to table VI. If one or more sample units fail to meet any specified requirement, the lot shall be rejected.

4.2.3 Examination of preparation for delivery. Shipping containers shall be examined for the defects listed in table IX to determine conformance to the packaging, packing, and marking requirements specified herein. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The sample size shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, except that it need not be sealed. The inspection level shall be S-2 of MIL-STD-105. The acceptable quality level shall be 2.5 defects per 100 units (one class of defects).

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* TABLE V. Testing of Materials

Characteristic	Test Method
Cloth for body (see 3.1.1 and table I)	
Identification of material	1/
Ply	visual 2/
Yarn, type and size	1/
Texture (wales and courses)	5070 of FED-STD-191
Bursting strength	5120 of FED-STD-191
Color	visual 2/
Nonfibrous materials	2611 of FED-STD-191
Type of knit	visual 2/
Preshrinkage	1/
pH	2811 of FED-STD-191
Cloth for collarette (see 3.1.1 and table II)	
Identification of material	1/
Type of knit	visual 2/
Yarn size	4021 of FED-STD-191
Texture (wales and courses)	5070 of FED-STD-191
Color	9010 of FED-STD-191
Type of dye	1/
Nonfibrous material	2611 of FED-STD-191

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TABLE V. Testing of Materials (Cont)

Characteristic	Test Method
Shrinkage or elongation	5556 of FED-STD-191 3/
Colorfastness to combined laundering and bleaching	5605 of FED-STD-191
pH	2811 of FED-STD-191

1/ A certificate of compliance will be acceptable for this requirement; however, the Government will reserve the right to check test items to determine the validity of the certification.
2/ One determination per sample unit shall be made.
3/ The cloth for the collarette shall be conditioned in a relaxed supported state for 1 hour after drying and shall not be moistened or pressed before it is measured.

TABLE VI. Sample Sizes

Lot Sizes	Sample Sizes
800 or less	2
801 to 22,000	3
22,001 or over	5

TABLE VII. Classification of Defects

Defects	Major	Minor
Material defects		
* Any hole, cut, tear, drop stitch, thin area, or mend	X	
Any slub more than twice the thickness of normal yarn		X
Rowey yarn or tiger stripes or loose knitting causing sleasiness		X

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TABLE VII. Classification of Defects (Cont)

	Defects	Major	Minor
*	Miss-knit	X	
*	Smash	X	
	Color		
	Not specified color	X	
	Cleanness		
	Spots and stains 1/		X
	Two or more untrimmed ends more than 1 inch in length inside or outside of T-shirt		X
	Components		
	Any component missing or not as specified	X	
	Seams and stitchings		
	Any seam twisted, puckered or pulled, affecting appearance		X
	Needle chews	X	
*	Tight tension (stitches breaking when normal strain is applied to seam or stitching)		X
	Loose tension resulting in loosely secured seam		X
	Any part of T-shirt badly pleated or caught or twisted in any unrelated row of stitching	X	
	Any seam not trimmed		X
*	Seam not specified type	X	
*	Stitch not specified type	X	
	Number of stitches per inch more than maximum specified or less than minimum specified		X
	Any open seam, except on hems 2/	X	

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TABLE VII. Classification of Defects (Cont)

Defects	Major	Minor
Any open seam 1/2 inch or more on hems 2/		X
Skipped or broken stitches more than 1/2 inch 3/	X	
Bartacks and tacks omitted on collarette	X	
Bartack or tack misplaced on collarette, not serving intended purpose	X	
Bartack or tack insecure on collarette		X
Bartack on collarette less than 1/16 inch or more than 1/8 inch from folded edge or less than 3/8 inch or more than 5/8 inch long		X
Chain stitch run-off not secured		X
Collarette		
Collarette not double thickness of ribbed cloth	X	
Collarette improperly attached to body, affecting appearance or serviceability	X	
Collarette not one of types specified herein	X	
Collarette not uniform in width		X
* Width of collarette less than 7/8 inch or more than 1-1/8 inch		X
Hems of sleeves and bottom		
Hems omitted	X	
Width of hem not uniform throughout		X
Width of hem less than 1/2 inch or more than 1 inch		X
Hem not stitched over first end of stitching at least 1 inch		X

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TABLE VII. Classification of Defects (Cont)

	Defects	Major	Minor
	Marking (identification of product)		
*	Marking omitted, incorrect, or illegible		X
*	Lettering		
*	Color of lettering off shade		X
*	Lettering incorrect size or misplaced		X
*	Lettering omitted	X	
*	Lettering illegible	X	

1/ Unless otherwise specified herein, stains that are on the outside of the T-shirt (including the hems) and that are not clearly visible on the outside or spots and stains that are within 5 inches from the bottom of the T-shirt shall not be classified as defects. Grouping of more than two stains that individually do not exceed the tolerance but are within an area of 5 inches in combined directions shall be classified as a defect.
2/ Any broken stitch or two or more continuous skipped stitches shall be classified as an open seam.
3/ This defect shall be applicable only to stitches skipped or broken in the same row of stitching that do not constitute an open seam.

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TABLE VIII. Testing of End Item

Characteristics	Test Method
Colorfastness of lettering (see 3.3)	
Laundering	5610 of FED-STD-191
Bleaching	5600 of FED-STD-191
* Weight of conditioned T-shirts (see 3.4 and table IV)	1/
Shrinkage or elongation of measurements A, B, or C of figure 2 (see 3.4.1)	7556 of FED-STD-191 2/

1/ The twelve T-shirts of each size (the sample unit) shall be allowed to reach equilibrium under standard conditions as defined in FED-STD-191. Upon reaching equilibrium, each size (one dozen T-shirts) shall be weighed as a unit under standard conditions. The results shall be reported to the nearest 1.0 ounce.
2/ The T-shirts shall not be moistened nor pressed before they are measured. The T-shirts shall be conditioned after drying 1 hour in a relaxed supported state under standard atmospheric conditions before they are measured. The measurements shall be taken to the nearest 0.1 inch with the T-shirts laid flat as shown in figures 1 and 2. Shrinkage or elongation shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 (percent). Elongation shall be reported prefixed with a minus (-) sign.

TABLE IX. Examination of Preparation of Delivery

Examine	Defects
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; or improper size, location, sequence, or method of application
Materials	Any component missing
	Any component damaged, affecting serviceability
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, improper taping, loose strapping, or inadequate stapling
	Bulging or distortion of containers
	Heat-sealed seams of polyethylene bags open, noncontinuous, or crooked or vent hole missing or greater than 1/4-inch diameter

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TABLE IX. Examination of Preparation of Delivery (Cont)

Examine	Defects
Content	Number of polyethylene bags per shipping container more or less than specified Number of T-shirts per polyethylene bag more or less than specified 1/

1/ Four polyethylene bags from each shipping container in the sample shall be examined for this defect.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

* 5.1.1 Level A. Each T-shirt shall be folded in accordance with standard practice to approximate dimensions of 11 inches by 7-1/4 inches. One folded T-shirt shall be inserted in a snug-fitting, flat-type, clear-polyethylene-film bag. The thickness of the polyethylene shall be 0.00125 inch (plus or minus 20 percent). The polyethylene bag shall be formed with heat-sealed seams that are straight, continuous, and parallel to each other and the formed edges of the bag. The final closure of the bag shall be heat sealed with the heat seal made as close as possible to the open end. A 1/4-inch-diameter hole shall be made at one corner of each bag to allow excess air to escape.

5.1.2 Level C. T-shirts shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The supplier may use his standard practice if it meets this requirement.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

* 5.2.1 Level A. One hundred and twenty T-shirts of the same size and packaged as specified shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container assembled, closed, and reinforced to conform to type CF, class weather resistant, size 3A of MIL-B-17757. The fiberboard for the liner shall be grade 275. Level A packages shall be packed flat in the shipping container, two in length, two in width, and thirty in depth. The top and the bottom of the contents of each shipping container shall be completely covered with a sheet of 50-pound-minimum-basis-weight paper conforming to grade B of UU-P-268. Toward the end of the contract or if the quantity of T-shirts of the same size is less than the quantity of T-shirts required per shipping container, mixed sizes (see 5.3.1) may be packed in the same container.

* 5.2.2 Level B. One hundred and twenty T-shirts of the same size and packaged as specified shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container assembled and closed to conform to type CF, class domestic, size 3A of MIL-B-17757. The fiberboard for the box and the liner shall be grade 275. Level A packages shall be packed flat in the shipping container, two in length, two in width, and thirty in depth. The

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top and the bottom of the contents of each shipping container shall be completely covered with a sheet of 30-pound-minimum-basis-weight paper conforming to grade B of UU-P-268. Toward the end of the contract or if the quantity of T-shirts of the same size is less than the quantity of T-shirts required per shipping container, mixed sizes (see 5.3.1) may be packed in the same container.

5.2.3 Level C. T-shirts packaged as specified shall be packed in a manner to insure acceptance by the carrier and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with rules or regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

* 5.3 Marking. Packages (see 5.1.1 and 5.1.2) shall be marked as specified in 3.6. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.3.1 Mixed sizes. Each shipping container packed with mixed sizes (see 5.2.1 and 5.2.2) shall have securely attached to the end and side, directly under the printing or stenciling, a white paper label. The label shall be 5 inches by 4 inches. The words mixed sizes shall be plainly stamped or printed on the label; under these words shall be legibly stamped or printed the correct quantity and sizes contained therein.

*

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The T-shirt covered by this specification is intended to be used as an athletic shirt by male personnel.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification

(b) Size required (see 1.2)

(c) Applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

* 6.3 Standard color samples. Standard color samples may be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.

Custodian:
Air Force - 11

Reviewer:
Air Force - 82

Preparing activity:
Air Force - 11

Project No. 8415-F762

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

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